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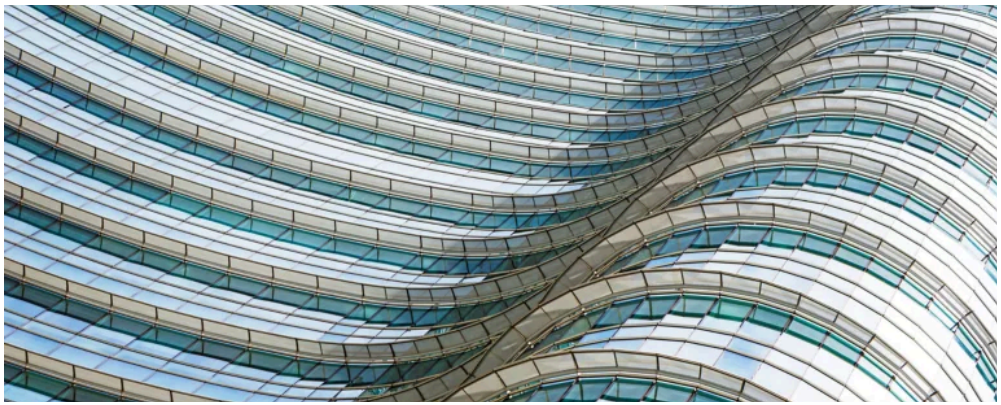
WELLINGTON MANAGEMENT®

Asset Allocation Outlook

February 2026 • 4 min read



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This is a monthly snapshot of Wellington Solutions' asset allocation views as of January 2026. It covers global equities, bonds and commodities and complements the more detailed analysis we share in our Quarterly Asset Allocation Outlook.

Key*

View			Change vs last month		
−	N	+	↑	NC	↓
Underweight	Neutral	Overweight	Up	No change	Down

*Please note that we use a more detailed key in our Quarterly Asset Allocation Outlook.

We further increased our overweight stance on global equities, supported by a constructive backdrop for risk assets marked by above trend growth, falling inflation, supportive fiscal policy and strong global earnings momentum. While valuations remain elevated, we expect robust earnings growth to continue driving returns. Regionally, we upgraded our view on emerging markets equities, while downgrading the UK and remaining neutral across other geographies.

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We remain neutral on US equities. We continue to expect low double digit earnings growth and we have seen earnings breadth improving meaningfully in recent quarters. Still, we see greater scope for other regions to grow their multiples and deliver stronger earnings growth and therefore prefer to express relative value views elsewhere.

Europe ex-UK

NC

We retain a neutral stance on European ex UK equities. While the region offers some upside from policy support, including German fiscal spending, we believe earnings expectations are too elevated relative to our estimates. In addition, political risk in France may resurface from mid year onwards and could weigh on European assets, leaving us comfortable maintaining a neutral stance for now.

UK

We downgraded our stance on UK equities to a modest underweight as we believe the UK market remains constrained by low earnings growth and a more defensive profile.

Japan

NC

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We upgraded our stance on emerging markets (EM) equities to a modest overweight. In our view, this is a region where all the stars look aligned: a supportive macroeconomic backdrop, a weak US dollar and strong AI driven capex extending the global semiconductor cycle and driving further earnings growth in Korea and Taiwan. In addition, we see inflation normalising in India and expect policy support in China to help boost consumer demand. We are most constructive on Korea and Taiwan but we are positive on the region as a whole given the very supportive backdrop.

We maintain a modestly overweight view on duration. At current yield levels, we think carry remains attractive. From a regional standpoint, our view on relative value trades has shifted to neutral, but we see value in re engaging should opportunities arise, with France and Japan currently the areas we are monitoring most closely. Overall, we continue to view duration as an important diversifier within a multi asset context.

US

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N

We upgraded our underweight view on European rates to neutral. The recent repricing has brought yields in line with our expectations, with the anticipated fiscal impulse and inflationary pressures, particularly in Germany, now largely priced in. While we have no regional views in place at present, we are closely monitoring France for opportunities to revisit our stance.

UK

N

We have dialled back our overweight stance on UK rates. While we continue to believe that markets are pricing in an excessive amount of fiscal risk for the UK, the disinflation trajectory now appears to be fairly reflected in current valuations. We have adjusted our view on positioning accordingly.

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Japan

We remain neutral on Japanese rates. Markets are now pricing in steady policy normalisation by the Bank of Japan in response to firmer inflation and stronger nominal growth. As such, we are maintaining a neutral stance for now, while looking for opportunities to revisit our stance.

We maintain a neutral stance in credit, given tight spreads. While valuations are also a constraint on the equity side, robust earnings help offset this. Tight credit valuations also come at a time when AI-related capex is likely to be funded partially in the investment-grade credit market. We are waiting for a better entry point to revisit our view, with EM debt remaining our preferred candidate.

Investment-grade credit

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NC

Our stance on high yield credit also remains neutral. Although all in yields are appealing, spreads are compressed to extreme levels, reinforcing our view that it may be preferable to stay on the sidelines for now.

Emerging markets

NC

We maintain a neutral view on EM debt. That said, the underlying fundamentals of the asset class are more constructive, making it our preferred area within credit; however, we are waiting for a better entry point before engaging.

NC

We retain our underweight stance on commodities, driven by our ongoing underweight view on oil. We continue to expect supply to outpace demand, putting further downward pressure on oil prices. We remain neutral on gold, acknowledging its long term structural appeal but waiting to revisit our view at more attractive levels.

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